LIU NANSHENG

Oil Painter · 1937 – 2025

Biography

Liu Nansheng (1937–2025) was a Chinese oil painter whose career spanned more than six decades, from 1950s Hangzhou through twenty-nine years of fieldwork in Xinjiang to a final three decades in California. Born in Quanzhou, Fujian, and raised in Shanghai, he received early artistic training at Tao Xingzhi's Yucai School before being admitted to the Zhejiang Academy of Fine Arts (now China Academy of Art) in 1953. After graduating in 1958, he was assigned to Xinjiang, where he spent the next twenty-nine years documenting the Uyghur, Kazakh, and Kyrgyz peoples through oil painting, sketching, and serialized illustration. He later worked in Guilin (1987–1992), travelled and exhibited in Kenya and South Africa (1992–1993), and immigrated to California in 1994, where he continued to paint until his passing in October 2025.

Education

- 1953–1958: Department of Oil Painting, Zhejiang Academy of Fine Arts (now China Academy of Art), Hangzhou. Studied under Li Binghong, Ma Sanhe, Fei Yifu, Ding Zhengxian, and Lü Hongren.
- 1949–1953: Yucai School (founded by Tao Xingzhi), Shanghai. Professional fine-art training.

Professional Appointments

- Deputy Chair and Associate Professor, Department of Fine Arts, Xinjiang Normal University
- Xinjiang Artists Association
- Xinjiang Exhibition Hall
- Guilin Regional Institute of Education (1987–1992)

Memberships

- Member, China Artists Association
- Member, American Society of Oil Painters
- Vice-Chair, Xinjiang Society of Art Education Research
- Vice-Chair, Guilin Regional Federation of Literary and Art Circles

Solo & Two-Person Exhibitions

- Double Joy Exhibition (with Jim Bliesner), San Diego, CA, USA, 1994
- Double Joy Exhibition (with Jim Bliesner), Millbrae, CA, USA, 1994
- Liu Nansheng and Students Exhibition, Johannesburg, South Africa, 1993
- Liu Nansheng Solo Exhibition, San Francisco City College, CA, USA
- Liu Nansheng Solo Exhibition, Foster City Art Gallery, CA, USA
- Liu Nansheng Solo Exhibition, Urumqi, Xinjiang

- Liu Nansheng Solo Exhibition, Guilin, Guangxi

Selected National Exhibitions (China)

- Selected to the National Art Exhibition six times
- Lunch of the Land Reclamation Team — National Art Exhibition, Beijing, 1960
- A Kyrgyz Schoolchild — National Ethnic Minorities Art Exhibition, Beijing
- Suite: Southern Xinjiang Scenes — Xinjiang Excellent Art Exhibition, Beijing & Urumqi
- Bringing Light and Warmth (poster) — National Poster Art Exhibition, Xi'an
- Grassland Doctor (serial picture) — National Chinese Painting & Serial Picture Exhibition, Lanzhou / Beijing / Hong Kong

Selected International Exhibitions

- Bridgehead — First Chinese Oil Painting Masterworks Exhibition, Japan
- The Coppersmith — International Chinese Artists Exhibition, Mexico
- Spring and Children on the Grass — 12th United Painting Society Art Year, El Cerrito, CA
- Feeding a Donkey — Contemporary Masters Exhibition, USA
- Boat in the Mist (pastel) — Chinese Pastel Exhibition, Taiwan & Singapore
- Father (pastel) — 5th International Pastel Annual, USA

Public Collections

- National Art Museum of China, Beijing — *The Livestock Market* (1983)
- Guilin Museum, Guangxi — *Emerald Bamboo of the Lijiang*
- China Academy of Art, Hangzhou — four drawings
- Xinjiang Museum, Urumqi — *Kizil Thousand-Buddha Caves*
- Private collection, Japan — *Bridgehead*
- Changqingfang, Taiwan — *Misty Morning on the Lijiang* (pastel)

Awards

- Memorial Award, El Cerrito Art Association, USA, 1996 — for Spring and An Interesting Performance
- Honorable Mention, Xinjiang Excellent Art Exhibition, 1985 — for the suite Southern Xinjiang Scenes
- Second-Class Provincial Scientific & Technical Achievement Award, Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region Government, 1984 — for Peaceful Liberation of Xinjiang (drawing)
- Trophy, China International Art Fair — for Mist over the Lijiang

Lectures & Teaching Abroad

- Department of Art, Nairobi College, Kenya, 1992
- Johannesburg, South Africa, 1993
- China Art Institute of San Diego, CA, USA, 1994
- Xinjiang Medical University, China

Selected Publications & Press

China: Liu Nansheng Painting Album (Changchun Publishing House); Meishu (Fine Arts, Beijing); full-spread features in Xinjiang Pictorial; serial-picture volumes from Xinjiang People's Publishing House; National Art Museum of China Collection Album; Guilin Museum Collection; Contemporary Chinese Oil Painting (UNESCO & China Translation and Publishing Corporation).

Hong Kong: The Artist; Liangyou.

USA: Fine Art Connoisseur; The Best of Portrait Painting; Always Bright; The Sun (San Diego); China Press.

Taiwan: Taiwan News.

Reference Dictionaries

- Dictionary of Chinese Artists (China)
- Dictionary of Modern Chinese Calligraphers and Seal-Carvers (Japan)
- World Dictionary of Modern Artists (China)
- Who's Who of Chinese-American Artists in North America (USA)

Other

At the 1994 opening of the Double Joy Exhibition (with American painter Jim Bliesner) in San Diego and Millbrae, California, the Deputy Consul General of the Chinese Consulate in Los Angeles attended in person; the Mayors of San Diego and Millbrae each delivered remarks and cut the ribbon. The Mayor of Millbrae issued a letter of commendation and declared the day of the exhibition opening the city's official “Double Joy Day.”

刘 南 生

油画家 · 1937 — 2025

生平简述

刘南生（1937—2025），中国油画家。1937 年生于福建泉州，少年时期在上海陶行知所办育才学校接受专业绘画训练，1953 年破格录取入浙江美术学院（今中国美术学院）油画系，师从黎冰鸿、马三和、费以复、丁正献、吕洪仁等。1958 年毕业后被分配到新疆，先后在新疆美术家协会、新疆展览馆、新疆师范大学美术系任职任教，任美术系副主任、副教授。1987 年调至桂林地区教育学院；1992 年自费赴肯尼亚、南非进行艺术考察；1994 年定居美国加州，直至 2025 年 10 月辞世。

教育背景

- 1953—1958　浙江美术学院（今中国美术学院）油画系，师从黎冰鸿、马三和、费以复、丁正献、吕洪仁
- 1949—1953　上海育才学校（陶行知创办），专业美术训练

工作经历

- 新疆师范大学美术系副主任、副教授
- 新疆美术家协会
- 新疆展览馆
- 桂林地区教育学院（1987—1992）

协会职务

- 中国美术家协会会员
- 美国油画家协会会员
- 新疆美术教育研究会副会长
- 桂林地区文艺界联合会副主席

个人画展

- 《双喜画展》（与美国画家 Jim Bliesner 合展）　San Diego, Millbrae, USA　1994
- 《刘南生师生画展》　Johannesburg, South Africa　1993
- 《刘南生画展》　San Francisco City College, USA
- 《刘南生画展》　Foster City Art Gallery, USA
- 《刘南生画展》　新疆乌鲁木齐市
- 《刘南生画展》　广西桂林市

国内重要展览（选）

- 六次入选全国美展
- 《垦荒队员的午餐》　全国美展　北京　1960
- 《柯尔克孜族小学生》　全国少数民族美展　北京
- 组画《新疆南部风情》　新疆好美展　北京、乌鲁木齐

- 《给人们带来光和热》（宣传画）　全国美展宣传画展　西安
- 《草原医生》（连环画）　全国中国画连环画展　兰州、北京、香港

国外展览（选）

- 《桥头》　中国首届油画精品赴日本展
- 《制铜匠》　国际中国美术家作品展　墨西哥
- 《春》、《草地上的孩子》　第十二届联合画会艺术年　El Cerrito, USA
- 《喂驴》　当代名家书画展　美国
- 《雾中之船》（粉画）　中国粉画展　台湾、新加坡
- 《父亲》（粉画）　第五届国际粉画年展　美国

公共收藏

- 中国美术馆　《牲畜市场》（1983）
- 桂林博物馆　《漓江翠竹》
- 中国美术学院　素描四幅
- 新疆博物馆　《克孜尔千佛洞》
- 日本　《桥头》（私人收藏）
- 台湾长青坊　《漓江晨雾》（粉画）

获奖

- 《春》、《有趣的表演》　1996 年 EL Cerrito Art Association Memorial Award
- 组画《南疆风情》　1985 年新疆好画展　佳作奖
- 《新疆和平解放》（素描）　1984 年新疆维吾尔自治区政府　省科技成果二等奖
- 《漓江烟云》　中国国际文艺博览会　奖杯

国内外讲学

- 肯尼亚　Art Department of Nairobi College　1992
- 南非　Johannesburg　1993
- 美国　China Art Institute of San Diego　1994
- 中国　新疆医学院

出版与媒体（选）

国内：《刘南生画集》（中国长春出版社）；《美术》（北京）；《新疆画报》整版发表；新疆人民出版社出版连环画单行本及多幅宣传画；《中国美术馆藏画集》（北京）；《桂林博物馆藏画》（桂林）；《中国当代油画艺术》（联合国科教文组织与中国对外翻译出版公司）。

香港：《美术家》、《良友》。

美国：Fine Art Connoisseur、The Best of Portrait Painting、Always Bright、《太阳报》（San Diego）、《侨报》。

台湾：《台湾新闻》。

入选辞典

- 《中国美术家人名词典》（中国）
- 《中国现代书画篆刻家名鉴》（日本）
- 《世界现代美术家大辞典》（中国）
- 《北美华裔艺术家名人录》（美国）

其他

1994 年，刘南生与美国画家 Jim Bliesner 于美国 San Diego 与 Millbrae 联合举办《双喜画展》开幕式上，中国驻洛杉矶总领事馆副总领事莅临祝贺；San Diego 与 Millbrae 两市市长分别为画展剪彩并致辞；Millbrae 市长签发褒奖信，并宣布画展开幕日为该市的“双喜日”。